South Marston Parish Council

SMPC response to S/RES/25/1389: Parcels R1 and R2 South Marston

22/11/2025

South Marston Parish Council is very grateful to have a plan that, for once, displays land use outside the red line so that connectivity and impact can be appropriately judged.

We have no major objection to the overall layout or the mix of housing and we like the roofscapes and street scenes offered. The provision of PV panels and sustainable energy measures are all welcome. The parking mix overall is good with 31 visitor spaces evenly allocated.

We OBJECT to the approval of this application until an assessment of potential for utilities connections to existing houses within or adjacent to the development parcel has been submitted and approved in compliance of Local Plan Policy RA3 and South Marston Village Neighbourhood Plan Policies 11 and 12.

The points below are where we ask for amendments in the detailed proposals:

Boundary with Oxleaze Wood

Footpath access into Oxleaze Wood from the majority of R1/R2 seems awkward. It is only accessible over unadopted, shared surface roads.

Prior to the point of access to the wood being 'fixed' at this corner, liaison with SBC Community Forest and the Parish Council is needed to check whether this meets internal constraints within Oxleaze Wood.

The '*3m indicative ditch location'* bordering Oxleaze Wood towards the south would appear to allow flexibility in locating the above access, presumably with a bridge/culvert over the ditch.

Potential adopted road connection into Manor Farmyard to enable development.

The current overarching 'plan' is for this to be within the open space area '*to be designed by others'* just north of the shared drive access shown left.

For this to be realistic, we need confirmation that an access (as 'agreed' by SBC planning officer in recent correspondence, and consistent with the Strategic Design Code) will meet with SBC Traffic Officer approval. It is currently on an outside bend, but could potentially be located anywhere along the Loop Rd boundary with the Open Space area.

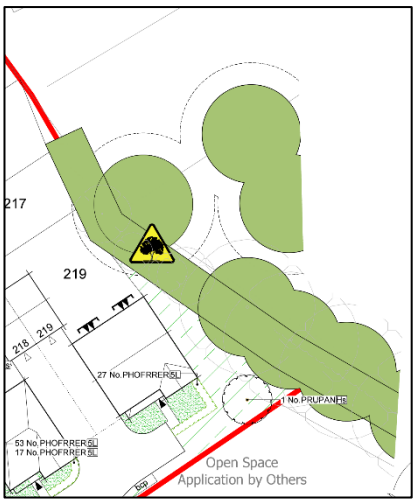
Central Key Space in R1

In the previous R1/R2 plans, there was a small green 'key space' area identified at the junction of the Loop Rd with the first road off to the west, and this met with SMPC approval. This now looks to be a front garden of dwelling 172. We ask for measures to be applied to ensure the reduced 'open aspect' that the front garden now provides is retained into the future.

Cycleways/footpaths

There is a need for safe cycle access along the full length of the Northern Loop Road. We anticipate a requirement for a 3.5m shared use footpath along one side of this road as it moves through, and in and out of the plan area. It is not clear that this is accommodated on these plans, even if construction of the Loop Road is to be '*delivered by others'* (i.e. via current plans for the Northern Loop Rd). A 2m footway on either side of the road is currently indicated.

Landscaping Plan



We note the plan is not showing that all three of the mature oaks on the boundary shown opposite have TPOs (plots 217-219). House 219 is currently quite close to one of these oaks and the crown will overhang its back garden.

All the landscaping shown here exists and is in third party ownership. There is apparently no additional landscaping to be provided on the boundary to strengthen separation with third-party land to the east.

To the north of this area, no existing landscaping is to be provided on the full length of the red line boundary all the way up to the planned Open Space Area adjacent to the bend in the Loop Road. We note that, instead, a 1.8m close-boarded fence is the planned boundary treatment for this stretch (Materials and Means of Enclosure Plan submitted as part of the application) and we object to that.

In other parcels in this overall development, <u>such fencing has only been allowed internal to the housing parcel site</u>. External boundaries were all required to be either landscaped, walled or with less unsightly iron railings.

Section 38 affordable housing/parking alongside the Loop Road.

Generally, we approve the parking plan and the availability and good distribution of visitor parking across R1 and R2. We do, however, have significant concerns about the terraces and parallel parking spaces on the Northern Loop Road.

As an example, the terrace arrangement (left) provides for allocated parking spaces, two per property, broken up by occasional planting.

We dislike this arrangement at this location. It presents a view along the stretch of the main Loop Rd of parallel-parked vehicles and these also dominate the view from both the road approaches to the corner.

It is classified as allocated parking, but presumably designed to be part of the public realm given the full-length footpath access to the houses to the rear of the parking spaces. Clarity is required as to how the 'allocation' by house is to be denoted and policed.

In general, we do not like the necessity of reversing out of parking spaces onto the main, through road that serves the R1/2 parcels on the grounds of road safety and street scene.

For the particular housing blocks shown in this extract, we query the availability of access to the rear gardens of some of these terraced properties, and we are conscious that, given the hedgerows at the rear, access will be required for maintenance.

Colin McEwen, Chair, SMPC
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